

Project Proposal: Detach

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1. Executive Summary

Detach is a digital well-being mobile application designed to help users reclaim their time and attention. By allowing users to set a dedicated focus timer that temporarily restricts access to distracting apps and websites, Detach fosters healthier digital habits. This project also serves as a foundational, hands-on learning experience for mastering Flutter and mobile application development.

2. Problem Statement

In today's hyper-connected world, smartphone addiction and digital distractions are significant barriers to productivity and mental well-being. Notifications, social media feeds, and the constant urge to check one's phone fragment attention spans, making it difficult to study, work deeply, or remain present in daily life.

3. Proposed Solution

Detach provides a frictionless way to enforce physical and digital boundaries. By activating a "Focus Session," the user voluntarily locks themselves out of predefined time-wasting apps for a set duration. This artificial barrier breaks the subconscious habit of "doomscrolling" and encourages intentional phone usage.

4. Target Audience

- **Students:** Needing uninterrupted focus for studying and assignments.
- **Professionals/Freelancers:** Looking to maximize productivity during deep work blocks.
- **General Smartphone Users:** Anyone feeling overwhelmed by screen time and wanting to build healthier digital boundaries.

5. Core Features (MVP - Minimum Viable Product)

These are the foundational features you should focus on building first to get a working app.

- **Focus Timer:** A simple, customizable countdown timer where users can select how long they want to disconnect (e.g., 15, 30, or 60 minutes).
- **App Blocking/Shielding:** The core functionality that prevents opening selected distracting apps while the timer is active.
- **Distraction Selection:** A settings menu allowing users to choose which specific apps they want to block during a session (e.g., Instagram, TikTok, Twitter).

- **Emergency Exit:** A way to cancel the timer if absolutely necessary (perhaps with a small friction element, like long-pressing a button for 5 seconds, to prevent easy quitting).

6. Future Enhancements (Stretch Goals)

These are ideas to keep in mind for later, once the core app is working perfectly.

- **Strict Mode:** Removes the "Emergency Exit" button entirely for users who need maximum enforcement.
- **Usage Statistics:** A dashboard showing how much "focused time" the user has accumulated over the week or month.
- **Scheduled Sessions:** The ability to automatically trigger Detach at certain times (e.g., Monday-Friday from 9 AM to 11 AM).
- **Gamification:** Earning streaks, badges, or virtual rewards for completing focus sessions without trying to open blocked apps.

7. Project Goals & Success Criteria

- **Primary Goal:** Successfully design, develop, and deploy a functional mobile app using Flutter, gaining practical experience in UI/UX design, state management, and native device permissions.
- **Secondary Goal:** Create a stable application that successfully intercepts or blocks other apps on the device for the duration of the set timer.
- **Success Metric:** A working prototype installed on a physical device that flawlessly completes a 10-minute focus session without allowing access to a blocked app.